

PERFORMANCE WORK STATEMENT

VA FSC Customer Service Representative Support for Financial Operations and Payroll Services

1.0 BACKGROUND

The Department of Veterans Affairs (VA) Financial Services Center (FSC) is a Franchise Fund site authorized pursuant to the Government Management Reform Act of 1994 (Public Law 103-356). The Act authorizes designated agencies to provide certain common administrative support services on a reimbursable basis both internally and to other Government agencies. Permanent status was conferred upon the VA Franchise Fund under the "Military Quality of Life and Veterans Affairs Appropriations Act, 2006," Public Law 109-114. Consequently, the VA FSC receives no federally-appropriated funding and is required to market VA FSC services to customers.

The VA Financial Services Center (VA FSC) supports the Department of Veterans Affairs by delivering innovative financial and data analytics services that enable VA customers to focus on Veterans, their families, and their caregivers. To fulfill this mission, the VA FSC provides a broad range of financial services organized into specific functional areas. This requirement establishes Call Center and Help Desk support, providing Customer Service Representatives (CSRs) who handle high-volume phone, email, and CRM-based inquiries for two major VA FSC divisions: the Financial Operations Service (FOS) Customer Engagement Commercial Division (CECD) and the Financial Payroll Service's (FPS) VA Time and Attendance System (VATAS) Customer Support team.

Historically, CECD process approximately 193,098 calls and 158,716 emails annually, averaging 16,091 calls and 13,226 emails per month, while VATAS Customer Support manages roughly 900 calls per week, 4,000 calls per month, and 50,000 calls annually, along with an average of 8,854 CRM tickets per month and 106,267 tickets per year. These combined workloads reflect a sustained enterprise demand for timely, accurate, and reliable customer service across system access, timekeeping, leave management, troubleshooting, and other operational support activities

The incumbent for the requirement is G2 Innovative Solutions, Inc. (G2IS).

2.0 OBJECTIVES

The objectives of this requirement are to provide call center and help-desk services that deliver timely, accurate, and customer-focused CSR phone and email support across two VA FSC functional areas: FOS CECD and FPS VATAS Customer Support. The Contractor shall ensure consistent responsiveness, accurate handling of inquiries, and reliable assistance in accordance with VA FSC service standards. Overall objectives are to achieve outcomes that include, but are not limited to:

- Providing knowledgeable, responsive customer support for CECD inquiries, ensuring accurate information and resolution within established service levels.
- Delivering high-quality support for VATAS timekeeping and payroll-related inquiries, including system navigation, troubleshooting, and guidance on time and attendance processes.

- Ensuring timely and accurate triage, documentation, and escalation of customer tickets in alignment with established workflows and escalation protocols.
- Maintaining full compliance with VA FSC policies, procedures, and federal data-security requirements.
- Promoting a positive customer experience through clear, professional communication and consistent service delivery.
- Supporting continuous improvement by identifying recurring issues and recommending enhancements to customer service processes.

3.0 SCOPE

The Contractor shall provide comprehensive Customer Service Representative (CSR) support to the VA Financial Services Center (FSC), delivering timely and accurate customer assistance across CECD financial operations and VATAS time and attendance functions. This support includes responding to customer inquiries, assisting with system access and navigation, documenting interactions, and ensuring adherence to VA policies, procedures, and security requirements. Contractor services shall sustain operational continuity, promote efficient issue resolution, and support the mission objectives of both CECD and VATAS.

3.1. Summary of Services

The Contractor shall deliver customer support services that include responding to inquiries, documenting cases, triaging and routing issues, providing system guidance, and supporting basic troubleshooting for CECD and VATAS users. All services shall be performed in accordance with applicable VA FSC procedures and federal information security standards, ensuring consistent, compliant, and customer-focused service delivery. Services within the scope of services include but are not limited to achieving the objectives of this requirement as noted herein.

4.0 SPECIFIC TASKS & REQUIREMENTS

Tasks in relation to this support are as follows:

4.1. TASK 1: PROJECT MANAGEMENT (CLIN 0001)

The Contractor shall provide comprehensive Project Management for the duration of the contract, serving as the primary point of contact with the Government and overseeing the overall management, coordination, and execution of all tasks under this PWS. Project Management responsibilities include directing day-to-day operations to ensure compliance with contract requirements; coordinating staffing, scheduling, and resource allocation to meet performance standards; monitoring progress, resolving issues, and delivering regular status updates to the Contracting Officer's Representative (COR) and designated Government personnel; and ensuring the timely submission of all required reports and deliverables. The Project Management function shall remain available during normal business hours, respond to Government inquiries within agreed-upon timelines, and possess the authority, experience, and qualifications necessary to make decisions on behalf of the Contractor and effectively manage complex customer service operations.

4.1.1. Kick-Off Meeting (SLIN 0001AA)

The Contractor shall attend a **Kick-off Meeting (Deliverable 1a)** and collaborate with COR for creation of meeting agenda slides as well as collaborating with COR to establish a meeting to review the goals and schedule of the project with the Government Point of Contacts. The meeting shall be held virtually via the Microsoft TEAMS application and is attended by Government staff typically including the Program Manager (PM), Contracting Officer Representative (COR), Contracting Officer (CO), or Contract Specialist (CS) along with Contractor Key Personnel and others appropriate to agenda topics and actionable items (action items). The Contractor shall collaborate with the COR to review meeting topics and provide a post meeting summary record of all action items identified in the Kickoff Meeting.

The Contractor shall collaborate with the COR to review meeting topics for setting an agenda and Contractor contribution of **Agenda Slides (Deliverable 1b)** for which the COR will incorporate to the presentation slides distribute prior to meeting.

The Contractor shall collaborate with the Government to establish initial **Action Items (Deliverable 1c)** identified during the Kick-Off meeting. Action Items are notable elements of performance, workflow and prioritization of efforts that are identified in order to provide key elements of performance of the work and/or its prioritization and other parameters of the effort to be performed and provide better insight and tracking transparency for Government and Contractor as to status of the effort and its progress and any issues that may have presented during the progress of the requirement. Generally, Action Item status is typically reviewed and establishes overall priorities of workflow and are reviewed up front and updated in any subsequent meetings and/or reports in lieu of meeting minutes in lieu of meeting minutes and minutes reviews. Action Items are a “living” item that are intended to place a focus on priorities and are intended to assist both Government and Contractor in focusing on current priorities of the workflow. At a minimum, the Kick-off meeting slides shall include the following topics:

- Introductions from Contractor Staff and Government employees involved in this contract
- A brief Contracting Officer overview of general contract and Government contract-related policy and regulations
- A brief overview of project administration and reporting by the Contactor
- A review of tasks by the Contractor to forge a common understanding of work to be performed, responsibilities, and Government’s priorities for the Contractor
- Review of the draft Staffing Plan
- Review of the draft Project Management Plan (PMP)
- Review of Action Items, updating or adding Action Items
- Collaborating and working to agree upon action items.

DELIVERABLES:

- 1a. Kick-Off Meeting
- 1b. Agenda Slides
- 1c. Action Items

4.1.2. Contract Project Management (SLIN 0001AB)

The Contractor shall provide services for Contract Project Management Planning that includes but is not limited to the following. The Contractor shall coordinate with the COR to provide the **Project Management Plan (PMP) (Deliverable 2)**. The Contractor shall develop, provide, maintain, and

adhere to the PMP that describes the management strategy, approach, controls, processes, and efforts that will be utilized to effectively plan and execute the requirements of this contract. The PMP should take the form of both a narrative and graphic format that displays the schedule, milestones, risks and resource support. A draft PMP shall be submitted as part of the Contractor's proposal. The Draft PMP with updates will be reviewed with the Contractor Program Manager and COR or appropriate Government representative, and updates shall be provided following the Kick-Off Meeting as outlined in the Deliverable Table. The PMP shall be considered a living document and may be revised or updated upon agreement between the COR and the Contractor's Program Manager.

4.1.3. Quality Control Plan (QCP) (SLIN 0001AC)

Additionally, CPMP will include integration of an effective **Internal Quality Control Program (QCP) (Deliverable 3)** to ensure that services performed are in accordance with the PWS. The QCP shall describe the standards and methodology used to ensure the quality and delivery of services and products meet task specifications.

4.1.4. Staffing Plan (SLIN 0001AD)

The Contractor shall provide a **Staffing Plan (Deliverable 4)** that provides the layout and expectations to meet the Level of Effort (LOE) required for performing the requirements of this PWS successfully. A draft of the staffing plan is due with submission of the proposal. The staffing plan shall include descriptive information regarding applicable experience, transitioning in/out, hiring, on-boarding, retention, training, replacement of staff, at a minimum that demonstrates an overall plan of how the Contractor will manage their employees, and any subContractors as applicable. In addition to the above, the Staffing Plan shall include, but is not limited to providing:

- Retention Strategy – The Contractor shall identify the retention strategy to minimize staff turn-over
- Staffing Transition Strategy – The Contractor shall identify the transition strategy to move responsibilities from personnel exiting/leaving the program to personnel accepting the associated responsibilities.

4.1.5. Progress Planning Meeting (SLIN 0001AE)

The Contractor shall attend a **Planning Meeting (Deliverable 5)** for which Key Personnel and other appropriate staff shall attend virtually (typically via TEAMS) with the COR and applicable Program Management staff. This meeting shall include a review of Action Item status and conclude by updating action items as applicable to the meeting discussion. Topics include, but are not limited to:

- Next Steps/Actions Planned
- Issues and Risks
- Staffing Updates (open positions, leave and coverage, etc.)
- Review of Action Items

4.1.6. Status Report (SLIN 0001AF)

The Contractor shall provide the **Status Report (Deliverable 6)** in a single Microsoft Excel workbook, with individual tabs separating each task area where work is occurring. Each tab shall

contain the required information for that task area. Reports shall reflect data as of the last day of the preceding month and shall include all work completed during the reporting period, planned work for the subsequent period, and identification of any problems encountered, including resolutions or plans and timelines for unresolved items. The Contractor shall communicate with the COR as needed to prevent escalation of outstanding issues. At a minimum, each task-area tab shall address:

- Status of action items
- Budget and period of performance
- Significant issues and recommended resolutions
- Activities completed
- Activities planned
- Personnel on-boarded
- Contractor Personnel Roster
- Planned personnel vacancies or absences and associated coverage plans
- Financial performance
- Status of GFE
- Monthly burn rate and hours usage
- Summary metrics

This report shall be subject to updates throughout the period of performance to include relevant information regarding the general status of contract activities, including technical, financial, and managerial issues.

4.1.7. Transition Plan (SLIN 0001AG)

The Contractor shall develop and execute a comprehensive **Transition Plan (Deliverable 7)** that covers both incoming and outgoing phases, minimizes disruptions to Government activities, and ensures a smooth handoff of responsibilities, knowledge, and ongoing work.

Incoming Transition:

The plan shall provide for an incoming transition approach that ensures a timely and orderly assumption of all contract duties. This includes reviewing existing documentation, conducting personnel onboarding, and coordinating with Government staff and any outgoing Contractor to understand ongoing priorities, workflows, and system access requirements. The Contractor will identify key personnel, establish communication channels, and outline milestones for full operational capability. The incoming transition plan will define how the Contractor intends to gain familiarity with current processes, capture institutional knowledge, and ensure continuity of services with no lapses in support.

Outgoing Transition:

The plan shall also provide for an outgoing transition approach that facilitates the seamless turnover of responsibilities at contract completion or transition to a follow-on Contractor. This includes preparing all required documentation, updating work products, and transferring knowledge, tools, accounts, and relevant records. The Contractor shall cooperate fully with the Government and any incoming Contractor to support an effective handoff and avoid delays or disruptions to mission activities. The outgoing transition plan will include timelines, roles,

responsibilities, and clear expectations for close-out and turnover activities, including return/disposition of GFE/GFI/GFP.

4.1.8. Daily Attendance, Staffing and Labor Tracking Time Entry (LTTE) – (SLIN 0001AH)

The VA-FSC requires comprehensive **Labor Tracking Time Entry (LTTE) Time Entry (Deliverable 8a)** attendance reporting for all Contractor personnel assigned to this requirement. The VA-FSC utilizes LTTE to track time entry for activity-based costing. The Contractor shall ensure that time entry and other information necessary to support time entry are accurately recorded in the current system in use within prescribed timelines and in accordance with guidance provided by the VA-FSC Cost Accounting Section (CAS). LTTE entry is a required administrative activity.

The Contractor shall submit a **Daily Attendance Report (Deliverable 8b)** identifying all personnel who are absent, late, or scheduled to leave early. This report shall be submitted twice each business day: a morning report provided and an afternoon report. Reports shall be submitted via email using a standardized format approved by the Government typically excel, with entries clearly indicating attendance status, schedule changes, and any known early departures or unplanned absences. The Contractor shall transmit each report via email to the COR and designated Government leads.

DELIVERABLES:

- 3. Project Management Plan (PMP)
- 4. Quality Control Plan (QCP)
- 5. Staffing Plan
- 6. Planning Meeting
- 7. Status Report
- 8a. Transition Plan
- 8b. LTTE Time Entry
- 8c. Daily Attendance Report

4.2. TASK 2: CECD SUPPORT - (CLIN 0003).

The VA FSC CECD operates as an enterprise-wide Tier 1 support, providing front-line customer service and system support for a broad spectrum of financial, travel, and payroll-related inquiries. CECD serves as the primary point of contact for VA staff, vendors, providers, and other external stakeholders who require assistance with payments, claims, system access, and financial transaction support. Users rely on CECD to report issues, obtain guidance, request system access, and resolve processing obstacles that affect their ability to complete required mission-critical financial and payroll activities. The Contractor shall deliver Tier 1 services supporting CECD's two primary functional areas: Station Support (Teams 1 and 2) and Vendor Support (provider and customer support teams).

Who the Contractor Supports (End Users)

End-users include VA station financial staff, VA program offices, commercial vendors, medical providers, and other external customers who experience challenges related to payments, claims, system access, or financial transactions. These users contact CECD through the Customer

Relationship Management (CRM) system, email, or telephone and rely support to resolve or triage issues.

Systems Utilized by CECD Support

Contractor personnel shall use CECD's Customer Relationship Management (CRM) portal as the primary tool for receiving, processing, documenting, and resolving customer inquiries and/or cases. A case in a CRM is a single record that captures a customer's issue, request, or inquiry from the moment it's reported through its final resolution. It provides a centralized place to document the customer's details, the nature of the problem, any troubleshooting steps taken, and all related communications. By tracking this information in one place, cases help support teams stay organized, ensure timely follow-up, and maintain a clear history of what was done and why. Ultimately, cases serve as the core mechanism for managing customer service interactions and ensuring consistent, accountable support. They may also reference financial and system resources such as iFAMS, payment tracking portals, vendor file systems, and relevant FSC standard operating procedures as part of Tier 1 troubleshooting and customer assistance.

Contractor Staffing Requirement

Based on prior performance periods, the level of effort associated with the CECD CSR Lead position has averaged 3,840 labor hours across the period of performance. In addition, the core CECD CSR services described in Sections 4.2.2 and 4.2.3 have historically required approximately 87,840 labor hours to sustain operational workload. During these periods, CECD Customer Support operations have processed approximately 193,098 calls annually (averaging 16,091 calls per month) and 158,716 emails annually (averaging 13,226 emails per month). The Contractor shall ensure sufficient staffing and labor availability to meet these historical service hour requirements and workload volumes, or any updated requirements as directed by the Government. These hours and workload metrics represent the anticipated level of effort necessary to maintain timely, accurate, and uninterrupted customer service operations in support of CECD mission objectives. The Government provides these historical estimates to assist the Contractor in planning, allocating, and sustaining adequate resources to support all required services.

4.2.1. CECD Team Lead Support (SLIN 0002AA)

The Contract Lead shall focus on oversight, coordination, quality assurance, and performance management activities over both Station Support and Vendor Support. The historical Level of Effort (LOE) for this requirement is 3,840 hours.

The Contract Lead may be required to perform limited routine CSR call handling or email response support to maintain service levels, address temporary workload increases, or support operational continuity. The Contractor shall determine the appropriate level of direct CSR support performed by the Lead, provided such support remains minimal and does not interfere with the Lead's primary management responsibilities.

The Team Lead Designees shall provide support services that include, but are not limited to:

- Monitoring Contractor morning and afternoon attendance
- Monitoring phone queues for Contractor employee login and activity throughout shifts.
- Contacting team members online for status updates.

- Remaining online and responding to Contractor employee messages, customer chats, and emails
- Following up on customer issues and resolutions regarding Contractor individual performance.
- Assisting Contractor employees with IT issues and submitting IT tickets when appropriate
- Coordinating with Government management regarding contract employee performance, documenting actions taken.
- Maintaining a Daily Log of updates, customer requests, and tasks.
- Reviewing LTTE reports for accuracy against timecards
- Correcting discrepancies in LTTE
- Supporting Contract new hires with LTTE
- Assisting with on and offboarding tasks
- Perform limited routine CSR call handling or email response support

4.2.2. Station Support (SLIN 0003AB)

The Contractor shall provide VA-FSC CECD Station Support providing services internally to VA employees which will typically are received from requests through Microsoft TEAMS, telephone calls and CRM cases. The historical Level of Effort (LOE) for this requirement is 3,840 hours.

Services to be supported include, but are not limited to:

- Working email listener interactions through the Get Most Urgent (GMU) button within CRM and create cases.
- Logging all phone interactions with customers in CRM and creating Cases in relation to track interactions and responses as well as for follow-up.
- Ensuring to respond to all assigned emails and create cases in CRM if applicable.
- Utilizing various VA-FSC and VA systems within the VA network firewall to research customer inquiries.
- Interpreting regulations, policies, and procedures to analyze information and providing accurate, easily understood back to VA customers Responses
- Directing issues to the appropriate team or escalating issues to the Government for resolution as necessary and determining when requests need to be forwarded to upper-tier support.
- Providing clear and concise information found by Tier I/II documenting the Customer Requests
- Following VA-FSC CECD Standard Operating Procedures, job aids, scripts, and the direction of Contractor Leads when moving the process to the next tier.
- Ensuring attention to detail, conducting thorough research and responding in a timely manner for all emails, calls, cases that are assigned.
- Ensuring of maintain access to all systems and financial information applications actively
- Responding to inquiries on basic technical issues in accordance with CECD process and procedures.
- Assisting internal VA-customers with system access and unlocking accounts due to inactivity or login issues.
- Handling customer requests for payment status or expedite payments.

- Researching and resolving Tier one (1) rejected payments, Credit Memos, and Treasury Offset Program payments
- Transferring VA customers or items to the correct services within the FSC (e.g., Accounting for General Ledger questions, Payment Resolution for Bill of Collection) by establishing a CRM case.
- Utilizing VA-FSC and VA systems authorized by the VA FSC CECD Management
- Reviewing and interpreting relevant regulations, policies, and procedures to ensure compliance.
- Analyzing gathered information to support informed decision-making.
- Providing detailed reports and recommendations based on analysis.
- Enhancing operational efficiency and support program objectives.
- Interpreting information to provide a response that is accurate and easily understood by the customer.
- Updating and completing One Notes in accordance with training huddles and CECD Government team leads, coordinators, supervisors and managers.
- Providing comprehensive phone support services to ensure efficient and effective resolution of VA customer issues.

4.2.3. VA-FSC CECD Vendor Support (Provider & Customer) (SLIN 0003AC)

The Contractor shall provide VA-FSC CECD Vendor Support (Provider & Customer), providing services externally to VA, for which will typically stem from requests through Microsoft TEAMS, telephone calls and CRM. The historical Level of Effort (LOE) for this requirement is 84,000 hours.

Services to be supported include, but are not limited to:

- Monitoring and action all assigned work in CRM
- Logging all interactions with customers in CRM
- Ensuring expedient response to all assigned emails
- Utilizing various VA-FSC and VA systems within the VA network firewall to research customer inquiries.
- Interpreting regulations, policies, and procedures to analyze information and providing accurate, easily understood responses.
- Determining when requests are forwarded to upper Tier for resolution.
- Providing clear and concise documentation of customer requests
- Routing issues to another team or elevating them to the Government for resolution as necessary.
- Following VA-FSC CECD Standard Operating Procedures, job aids, scripts, and the direction of Contractor Leads when moving the process to the next tier.
- Responding to inquiries on basic technical issues in accordance with CECD process and procedures
- Registering customers for system access and unlock accounts due to inactivity or login issues.
- Handling customer requests for payment status or expedite payments.
- Researching and resolving Tier one (1) rejected payments, Credit Memos, and Treasury Offset Program payments

- Prompt Action to inquiries about Current Procedural Terminology (CPT) codes, inquiries about the reason a claim was rejected, establishment of a Bill of Collection, an accounting question, request for a corrected 2nd payment, inquiries about Benefit Travel, request to unblock a vendor's file.
- Transferring VA customer or item to the correct service within the FSC (e.g., Accounting for General Ledger questions, Payment Resolution for Bill of Collection) by establishing a CRM case.
- Transferring VA customers or items to the appropriate VA organization outside FSC (e.g., VA Medical Center for Benefit Travel questions, Office of Community Care for CPT code or claim denial questions) by providing a phone number and/or email address within one business day
- Utilizing VA-FSC and VA systems authorized by the VA FSC CECD Management
- Review and interpret relevant regulations, policies, and procedures to ensure compliance.
- Analyzing gathered information to support informed decision-making.
- Providing reports and recommendations based on analysis.
- Interpreting that information to provide a response that is accurate and easily understood by the customer.
- Determining when requests must be entered into the CRM tool and forwarded to upper Tier for resolution.
- Providing clear and concise documentation of the customer's request and information found by Tier I/II.
- Routing issues to another team or elevating them to the Government for resolution as necessary.
- Following VA-FSC CECD Standard Operating Procedures, job aids, scripts, and the direction of Contractor Leads when determining to move the process to the next tier.
- Providing comprehensive phone support services to TVA-FSC CECD and ensuring efficient and effective resolution of VA customer issues.

4.3. TASK 3: VATAS CUSTOMER SUPPORT TEAM (CLIN0004)

The VA Time and Attendance System (VATAS) Customer Support Team operates as an enterprise-wide Help Desk, serving as the first point of contact for over 400,000 VA employees who use VATAS for timekeeping, leave, attendance, and payroll-related functions. The Customer Support Team primary role is to provide front-line customer service, troubleshoot system and access issues, maintain user roles and profiles, and ensure accurate timekeeping data flows to payroll. The Contractor shall support this mission by providing trained CSRs and a Contractor Team Lead who deliver timely, accurate, and policy-aligned assistance to VATAS end-users.

End-users include:

VATAS serves a broad user community that includes VA employees and supervisors, Timekeepers and Time & Leave Approvers, payroll and administrative staff at VA stations, and Contractors and military personnel assigned VATAS roles. These users routinely contact the Customer Support Team through CRM tickets, email, or phone for assistance with system access, timekeeping, leave entry, tour-of-duty (TOD) updates, and other VATAS functions essential to maintaining accurate and compliant time and attendance processing across the VA.

Systems Used

Contractor personnel regularly use a suite of VA systems and operational tools to support timekeeping, troubleshooting, and customer service functions, including VATAS as the primary time and attendance system; CRM for ticket intake, documentation, routing, and tracking; Cisco Finesse and Jabber for call handling and reporting; Manager Tools for generating reports and metrics; Calabrio for quality review and call playback; HRSmart for verifying employee profile information; and various VA-specific onboarding and access systems such as RAP, VPN, YOUR IT, and APDS. Contractor staff also rely on Desk-Top Procedure Guides and VA policy documents to ensure accurate user verification, effective troubleshooting, proper case routing, and adherence to established VA standards and compliance requirements.

Contractor Staffing Requirement

The historical level of effort includes 3,840 hours for the Contract Lead and 57,536 hours for Customer Service Representatives (CSRs). Historical workload data reflects an average volume of approximately 900 calls per week, 4,000 calls per month, and 50,000 calls annually, in addition to an average of 8,854 CRM tickets per month and 106,267 tickets per year. This staffing level is necessary to ensure timely, accurate, and consistent support for VATAS users and to maintain continuity of operations across all timekeeping, leave, system access, and functional assistance activities.

4.3.1. VATAS Team Lead Services (SLIN0004AA)

The Contractor shall provide Team Lead level support services for coordinating and communicating between the Contractor's Team and the Government, which will primarily be the COR and Government Program Manager as well as the Contractor team management. VA has specific tools in relation to submission of help tickets that need triage within specific time intervals and resolutions within the tolerances of VA established goals for responses. Services related to Team Lead level support services require the Contractor to take an active stance on ensuring expedience in services and resolutions that involve working with these systems and troubleshooting tickets. The Contract Lead may perform limited routine CSR call handling or email response support to maintain service levels, address temporary workload increases, or support operational continuity. The Contractor shall determine the appropriate level of direct CSR support performed by the Lead, provided such support remains minimal and does not interfere with the Lead's primary management responsibilities. The historical Level of Effort (LOE) for this requirement includes 3,840 hours. Services, include, but are not limited to:

- Monitoring call queues via Cisco Finesse
- Reviewing live and recorded calls for quality (Finesse and Calabrio)
- Running phone performance and call volume reports
- Routing cases appropriately between Tier 0, Tier 1, and PHRSD
- Monitoring and triaging CRM ticket queues
- Assigning tickets, tracking updates, and ensuring timely resolution
- Updating daily ticket trackers and performance logs

- Managing account creation, access requests, onboarding/offboarding
- Handling RAP, VPN, YOUR IT, APDS, and other VA access workflows
- Reviewing new-hire packets and system provisioning requests
- Coordinating communications across Tier 1 Leads and Government staff
- Processing SVO, VACO, SPA chat requests
- Delivering announcements, operational updates, and workflow changes
- Providing monthly performance reporting and evaluations to management
- Performing administrative oversight tasks such as LTTE checks
- Performing limited routine CSR call handling or email response support

4.3.2. VATAS Customer Service Support (SLIN 0005AB)

VATAS requires Customer Service Support for routine, repeatable customer assistance related to role assignments, profile maintenance, timekeeping guidance, system usage, and basic troubleshooting. The historical Level of Effort (LOE) for this requirement is 57,536.

The Contractor shall perform the following functions as day-to-day operational support:

- Documenting each customer inquiry in CRM
- Determining whether issues can be resolved, or if they must be escalated
- Providing detailed notes when routing cases to Tier 1 or Government supervisors
- Assigning the appropriate roles to the Timekeepers, Supervisors, Time and Leave (TL) Approvers, Duty Station Payroll Admin/Technician, Station View Only, Station Payroll Admin/Technician.
- Un-assigning roles that no longer apply to the Timekeepers, Supervisors, TL Approvers, Duty Station Payroll Admin/Technician, Station View Only, and Station Payroll Admin/Technician
- VATAS sign-on requests shall be worked in accordance with established Desk top procedure guide and VA policies
- Review and process submitted single sign-on support request; and
- Research and assist / or advise the customer to contact the enterprise service Desk
- Assign the appropriate Time and Leave (TL) units to the appropriate Station
- Un-assign the appropriate TL units from the appropriate Station
- Prioritize cases based on TL Unit requirements in appropriate time received and work cases within a thirty-minute timeframe
- Work TL Unit cases in accordance with established Desk-top procedure guide and VA policies
- Assist Timekeepers, Supervisors, and TL Approvers with questions and providing guidance by reviewing timesheet or timesheet summary
- Answer routine inquiries pertaining to the use and operation of VATAS.
- Escalate non-routine (i.e. employee leave issues, timesheet overrides) or complex issues (i.e. employee entitlements, timekeeping issues) timesheet overrides, as required for appropriate Government staff.
- Close escalated calls will be the responsibility of the Government staff; and
- Answer inquiries on the proper procedural methods for using the system based on VA policy and guidance within the VA-FSC VATAS Desk-top procedure guide

- Verify the VATAS Employee Profile against the HRSmart system to ensure the employee's information (name/User ID and email addresses) are correct.
- Create/maintain temporary employee profile accounts for Contractors and Military personnel performing required roles within VATAS.
- Prioritize cases based on verification requirements. Verification of information shall be worked in accordance with established VA-FSC VATAS Desk-top procedure guide, guidelines and VA policies.
- Ensure the appropriate TOD Units are assigned to the appropriate Station and/or Duty Station.
- Verify TOD Units are assigned/unassigned in accordance with established VA-FSC VATAS Desk-top procedure guide, guidelines, and VA policies.
- Prioritize case based on verification requirements. Verification of information shall be worked in accordance with established VA-FSC VATAS Desk-top procedure guide, guidelines and VA policies.
- Assist Timekeepers in navigating timesheets and standardized reports.
- Escalate any requests for new reports to Tier (1) leads.
- Support VATAS Payroll Assessments and Validations in accordance with established guidelines that may include Desk-top procedure guide and VA policies.
- Support the timekeepers with timesheet issues in accordance with established guidelines that may include Desk-top procedure guide and VA policies. Timeframe will be determined at the beginning of the tasking.

4.4. TASK 4: SURGE SUPPORT (CLIN 0004) (OPTIONAL TASKS)

The Contractor shall provide for "Surge" support for requirements of tasks to provide an escalated level of response capability for occasional surges in demand over anticipated base levels of services. Surge support is geared toward providing additional coverage where volume of work exceeds the normal and to provide an additional capacity to the total period of performance hours where specific task areas require additional capacity that exceeds a normal flow of work.

The surge support is not meant to cover flexibility of normal workflow the Contractor should expect that varies depending on typical demand variability, but to supplement where volumes of work significantly are in excess of capacity and flexibility that would normally cover minor surges. The surge volume provides for a total of an additional overall 10% capacity above the normal task LOE for continuation of work that includes the expectation that there are highs and lows in the workflow on any given period and stretch beyond what flexibility is otherwise provided in total LOE and flexibility due to significant increases in work volumes.

As Optional Tasks, surge support SLINs will be exercised via modification to the Contract where performance requires additional overall LOE capacity due to excessive surges as determined by the COR and cover only up to the remaining time left in the existing period of performance in which the SLINs are exercised. Surge Capacity is

4.4.1. OPTIONAL TASK: SURGE SUPPORT FOR PWS 4.2 (CECD) (Optional Task) (SLIN 0004AA, 1004AA, 2004AA, 3004AA, 4004AA)

The Contractor shall provide surge support, as required by the Government, to meet short term increases in workload or mission requirements. Surge support shall include performing all tasks,

activities, and deliverables identified in PWS Section 4.2 in the same manner, quality standards, and timelines required for normal operations. Surge support shall consist of providing for requirements of a 10% surge in capacity for the requirements as related to PWS 4.2.

Surge support may be required for, at a minimum,

- Increases in volume of requirements described in PWS 4.2
- Short notice tasking or accelerated timelines
- Additional personnel, labor hours, or resources required to meet mission needs

**4.4.2. OPTIONAL TASK: SURGE SUPPORT FOR PWS 4.3 (VATAS) (Optional Task)
(SLIN 0004AB, 1004AB, 2004AB, 3004AB, 4004AB)**

The Contractor shall provide surge support, as required by the Government, to meet short term increases in workload or mission requirements. Surge support shall include performing all tasks, activities, and deliverables identified in PWS Section 4.3 in the same manner, quality standards, and timelines required for normal operations. Surge support shall consist of providing for requirements of a 10% surge in capacity for the requirements as related to PWS 4.3.

Surge support may be required for, at a minimum,

- Increases in volume of requirements described in PWS 4.3
- Short notice tasking or accelerated timelines
- Additional personnel, labor hours, or resources required to meet mission needs

4.5. TASK 5: TRANSITION REQUIREMENTS (OPTIONAL TASKS)

The Contractor shall provide transition support services necessary to ensure an orderly and uninterrupted assumption of contract responsibilities in accordance with the Government accepted Transition Plan in PWS section 4.1.7 for incoming and outgoing transitions related to this effort.

4.5.1. Incoming Transition Services (Optional Task) (CLIN 5001)

Transition for Incoming New Vendor, if necessary, will be exercised along with the award of the Contract/Order and is a one-time period of performance effective at the onset of the Base Period of Performance only.

The Contractor shall provide incoming transition support services to ensure a smooth and uninterrupted assumption of contract responsibilities. Under this optional task, the Contractor shall perform activities necessary to become fully oriented to the mission environment and prepared for operational performance. Services include reviewing current documentation and work products, conducting coordination sessions with Government stakeholders and the outgoing Contractor, assessing existing workflows and system access requirements, and validating the accuracy and completeness of inherited tasks. The Contractor shall provide relevant information or participation requested by the Government to support transition briefings, readiness checks, and onboarding activities. These services enable the Contractor to achieve full operational capability while ensuring continuity of Government operations.

4.5.2. Outgoing Transition Services (Optional Task) (CLIN 5002)

The Contractor shall provide outgoing transition support services to ensure an orderly and complete transfer of responsibilities at contract completion or when directed by the Government. Under this optional task, the Contractor Shall perform activities necessary to prepare all materials, documentation, and knowledge for turnover to the Government or an incoming Contractor. Services include updating and delivering work products, assisting with transfer of records and accounts, briefing follow on personnel on ongoing work, and supporting Government directed transition meetings. The Contractor shall cooperate fully to ensure the accuracy, completeness, and accessibility of all transition tasks. These services enable the Government to maintain continuity of operations and ensure a smooth, efficient transition with minimal disruption. This task is a one-time task to be exercised as required for handling outgoing transition services and making of arrangements for dispensation of all GFE/GFI/GFP.

This task shall be eligible to be exercised as necessary during any period determined by the Government to be the final period of performance.

5.0 DELIVERABLES & DELIVERABLE TABLE

The following table provides a summary of deliverables required under this contract. Due to the nature of the work, much of the day-to-day work and action items would be captured in the form of reports, either weekly, monthly, or quarterly, with the report being the inspectable deliverable, and action items status updates to be part of each meeting starting point.

CLIN/ SLIN #	PWS Section	Del #	Description	QTY	Delivery to	Delivery Method	Delivery Date
TASK 1 - PWS 4.1 - Project Management - CLIN 0001							
0001AA	4.1.1	1a	Attend Kick-Off Meeting	1	COR	MS Document	Within 10 days of Effective Date of Award, and within 5 business days of Option Exercise.
0001AA	4.1.1	1b	Agenda Slides	1	COR	Virtual	3 business days Prior to Kick-Off Meeting
0001AA	4.1.1	1c	Action Items	1	COR	MS Document (i.e. editable PowerPoint)	- Established at Kick-Off Meeting - Updated Quarterly at Minimum - Other as directed by COR
0001AB	4.1.2	2	Project Management Plan (PMP)	1	COR/P Ms	MS Document	- Draft due with Proposal - Final due 10 Business Days after COR review and feedback. - Updated as directed by COR
0001AC	4.1.3	3	Quality Control Plan (QCP)	1	COR	MS Document	- Draft due with Proposal - Final due 10 Business Days after COR review and feedback. - Updated as directed by COR
0001AD	4.1.4	4	Staffing Plan	1	COR	MS Document	- Draft due with Proposal - Final due 10 Business Days after COR review and feedback. - Updated as directed by COR
0001AE	4.1.5	5	Planning Meeting	24	COR	VIRTUAL – TEAMS	Bi-weekly second Thursday

0001AF	4.1.6	6	Status Report	11	• COR • Gov't Project Lead	MS Document (Editable Word, PowerPoint, PDF)	• NLT 5th Business Day of each month beginning Month 2 • Updates as requested by COR
0001AG	4.1.7	7	Transition Plan	1	COR	MS Document	• Draft due with Proposal • Final due 10 Business Days after Kick-Off Meeting
0001AH	4.1.7	8a	LABOR TRACKING TIME ENTRY (LTTE)	12	COR	LTTE System	LTTE Bi-weekly in conjunction with the last business day of the government pay period.
0001AH	4.1.8	8b	Daily Attendance Report	2x per Day	COR	Email to COR and Gov't Leads as requested by COR	2 times per day: AM report NLT 9AM Central Time and Afternoon Report NLT 1PM Central Time.

6.0 QUALITY CONTROL: TASK ORDER QUALITY ASSURANCE SURVEILLANCE PLAN (QASP)

6.1. Contractor's Quality Control Program (QCP)

CPMP will develop and maintain an effective Internal Quality Control Program to ensure that services performed are in accordance with the PWS.

6.2. Quality Assurance Surveillance Plan (QASP)

The Government will utilize a Quality Assurance Surveillance Plan throughout the of the contract to ensure that the Contractor is performing the services required by this PWS in an acceptable manner. The Government reserves the right to alter or change the surveillance methods in the QASP at its own discretion. A Performance Based Service Assessment Survey will be used in combination with QASP to assist the Government in determining acceptable performance levels. As such a Performance Requirement Summary (PRS) defines the Performance Standards and Acceptable Quality Levels (AQL) of Performance associated with this effort

Performance Requirements Summary (PRS)

PWS Section	Requirement	Standard / AQL	Incentive
4.1	Project Management	Standard AQL for Project Management: At least 95% compliance with project management requirements, including timeliness, accuracy, communication, and documentation quality. AQL: At least 95% of project management tasks, reports, and deliverables must be accurate, timely, and compliant with contract requirements.	Incentive: CPARS, Option Exercise.

4.1.1	Kickoff Meeting	Standard: Demonstrates productivity, communicates efficiently, identifies and corrects deficiencies AQL: Initial Draft 5 business days after award, Final deliverable 3 Business Days After Kick-Off and updates as required by COR and after any meetings. (BASE PERIOD ONLY)	Incentive: CPARS, Option Exercise.
4.1.2	Contractor Project Management Plan	Standard: Addresses Contractor Personnel Roster; Monthly and cumulative hourly burn rate; Monthly Metrics Summary, Update on any recruitment actions, Projected absences, Government Furnished Property Report AQL: Draft due with Proposal Final due 10 Business Days after award Updated as needed No more than (3) instances where the report requires revisions based off deficiencies. The Contractor must achieve a minimum of 95% compliance with all QCP requirements, including timeliness, accuracy, documentation completeness, communication standards, and adherence to approved processes.	Incentive: CPARS, Option Exercise.
4.1.3	Quality Control Plan (QCP)	Standard: implement and maintain an effective Quality Control Plan that ensures all project activities, deliverables, and performance outcomes meet contract requirements. The QCP must provide processes for monitoring performance, identifying deficiencies, implementing corrective actions, and preventing recurrence. AQL: The Contractor must achieve a minimum of 95% compliance with all QCP requirements, including timeliness, accuracy, documentation completeness, communication standards, and adherence to approved processes.	Incentive: CPARS, Option Exercise.
4.1.4	Final Staffing Plan	Standard: The Contractor shall provide a Staffing Plan that ensures sufficient, qualified personnel are available to perform all contract requirements. The plan must include recruitment, onboarding, retention, contingency staffing, key personnel coverage, and procedures to minimize service disruption. All staff must meet the qualifications, certifications, and experience levels defined in the contract.	Incentive: CPARS, Option Exercise.

		AQL: The Contractor must maintain a minimum of 90% staffing coverage for all required positions, including key personnel. Any vacancies must be filled within the timeframe specified IAW CPMP with at least 95% compliance with timely staffing actions, qualification requirements, and onboarding procedures.	
4.1.5	Progress Meeting	Standard: Demonstrates productivity, communicates efficiently, identifies and corrects deficiencies in Biweekly Meetings AQL: No more than three instances per month when deficiencies requiring corrective action are identified as missed by the Contractor	Incentive: CPARS, Option Exercise.
4.1.6	Status Report	Standard: The Contractor shall provide accurate, complete, and timely status reports that clearly outline project progress, risks, issues, accomplishments, upcoming activities, and any deviations from the project plan. Reports must follow the Government-approved format and be submitted at the frequency specified in the contract. AQL: The Contractor must achieve 95% accuracy and timeliness for all required status reports, ensuring they are submitted on or before the due date and contain all required information, with no more than 3 instances requiring correction or resubmission.	Incentive: CPARS, Option Exercise.
4.1.7	Transition Plan	Standard: implement and maintain an effective Transition Plan that ensures comprehensive transition plan that covers both incoming and outgoing phases, minimizes disruptions to Government activities, and ensures a smooth handoff of responsibilities, knowledge, and ongoing work. AQL: The Contractor must achieve a minimum of 95% compliance without significant service disruption.	Incentive: CPARS, Option Exercise.
4.1.8	Daily attendance & Labor Tracking Time Entry (LTTE)	Standard: The Contractor shall ensure all labor hours are accurately recorded, categorized, and submitted in the Government-approved labor tracking system. Time entries must reflect actual hours worked, be entered IAW FSC CAS policy. All entries must be complete, traceable, and free of discrepancies.	Incentive: CPARS, Option Exercise.

		AQL: The Contractor must maintain at least 98% accuracy and timeliness in labor time entry submissions. Time must be entered daily with no more than 3 of entries requiring correction, resubmission, or reconciliation due to inaccuracies, late submissions, or missing information.	
4.2	Customer Engagement Center Division CECD Support	Standard: Appropriate level of staffing and coverage. • Attendance Accuracy • Appropriate Coverage • Meeting Satisfactory Metrics AQL: No more than three instances per month when deficiencies requiring corrective action are identified as missed or not corrected by the Contractor.	Incentive: CPARS, Option Exercise.
4.2.1	CECD Team Lead	Standard: Demonstrates productivity, communicates efficiently, identifies and corrects deficiencies AQL: No more than three instances per month when deficiencies requiring corrective action are identified as missed or not corrected by the Contractor.	Incentive: CPARS, Option Exercise
4.2.2	Station Support (Team 1 and Team 2)	Individual Standard: Telephone or written/email inquiries result in a CRM Case 3% of the time or less. CRM Call Interaction cases are documented 100% Average phone call 8 minutes The average speed of answer (ASA) is required to be under three (3) minutes for phone inquiries with basic technical issues. Rolled over not answered (RONA) RONA target of 2% as the optimal goal with 5% or higher considered marginal to unsatisfactory. This will also include review to ensure that the RONA is valid. Telephone inquiries are processed according to VA-FSC instructions and work is 1.5% to 4.4% of the daily calls received by the section. Resolve all assigned emails within 24 hours unless awaiting additional	Incentive: CPARS, Option Exercise.

		information from the customer, (no more than 72 hours). Email inquiries are normally processed according to VA-FSC instructions and work 1.5% to 4.4% of the daily emails received by the section. Research and resolve Tier 1 rejected payment within one business day Research and resolve Tier 1 Credit Memo within one business day Research and resolve Tier 1 Treasury Offset Program payment within one business day AQL: No more than two instances per month per individual when deficiencies requiring corrective action are identified as missed or not corrected by the Contractor.	
4.2.3	VA-FSC CECD Vendor Support (Provider & Customer)	Individual Standard: Telephone or written/email inquiries result in a CRM Case 3% of the time or less. CRM Call Interaction cases are documented 100% Average phone call 8 minutes The average speed of answer (ASA) is required to be under three (3) minutes for phone inquiries with basic technical issues. Rolled over not answered (RONA) RONA target of 2% as the optimal goal with 5% or higher considered marginal to unsatisfactory. This will also include review to ensure that the RONA is valid. Telephone inquiries are processed according to VA-FSC instructions and work is 1.5% to 4.4% of the daily calls received by the section.	Incentive: CPARS, Option Exercise.

		Resolve all assigned emails within 24 hours unless awaiting additional information from the customer, (no more than 72 hours). Email inquiries are normally processed according to VA-FSC instructions and work 1.5% to 4.4% of the daily emails received by the section. Research and resolve Tier 1 rejected payment within one business day Research and resolve Tier 1 Credit Memo within one business day Research and resolve Tier 1 Treasury Offset Program payment within one business day AQL: No more than two instances per month per individual when deficiencies requiring corrective action are identified as missed or not corrected by the Contractor.	
4.3	VATAS Customer Support Team Services	Standard: Demonstrates productivity, communicates efficiently, identifies and corrects deficiencies The average phone call lasts 6 ½ minutes. Respond to all calls and cases within a 30-minute timeframe of phone call and/or email inquiry Monthly metrics Phone Team: 155 tickets in a month; 250 phones in a month; 405 total monthly. Actions Team: 400 tickets in a month; 5 phone calls in a month; 405 total monthly. AQL: No more than two instances per month per individual when deficiencies requiring corrective action are identified as missed or not corrected by the Contractor.	Incentive: CPARS, Option Exercise.
4.3.1	VATAS Team Lead	Standard: Demonstrates productivity, communicates efficiently, identifies and corrects deficiencies AQL: No more than two instances per month per individual when deficiencies requiring corrective action are identified as missed or not corrected by the Contractor.	Incentive: CPARS, Option Exercise

4..2	VATAS Customer Service Support	Standard: Demonstrates productivity, communicates efficiently, identifies and corrects deficiencies The average phone call lasts 6 ½ minutes. Respond to all calls and cases within a 30-minute timeframe of phone call and/or email inquiry AVG Monthly metrics (Individual) Tickets: 200 - 268 Calls: 100- 126 AQL: No more than two instances per month per individual when deficiencies requiring corrective action are identified as missed or not corrected by the Contractor.	Incentive: CPARS, Option Exercise.
4.4.2	VATAS Role Setup	Standard: Assign appropriate VATAS roles within a 30-minute timeframe AQL: No more than two instances per month per individual when deficiencies requiring corrective action are identified as missed or not corrected by the Contractor.	Incentive: CPARS, Option Exercise.
4.4.2	VATAS Single Sign-On	Standard: Complete all single sign-on requests and reviews within a 30-minute timeframe AQL: No more than two instances per month per individual when deficiencies requiring corrective action are identified as missed or not corrected by the Contractor.	Incentive: CPARS, Option Exercise.
4.4.2	VATAS Time and Leave (TL) Unit Setup	Standard: Assign TL units to the appropriate Station within a 30-minute timeframe Un-assign TL units from appropriate Station within a 30-minute timeframe AQL: No more than two instances per month per individual when deficiencies requiring corrective action are identified as missed or not corrected by the Contractor.	Incentive: CPARS, Option Exercise.
4.4.2	Assist Timekeepers / Supervisors / TL Approvers	Standard: Assist with review of timesheet or timesheet summary within a 30-minute timeframe. AQL: No more than two instances per month per individual when deficiencies requiring corrective action are identified as missed or not corrected by the Contractor.	

4.4.2	VATAS System Usage and Policy Inquiries	Standard: Answer routine inquiries pertaining to the use and operation of VATAS within a 30-minute timeframe. Escalate non-routine or complex issues to appropriate Government staff within 5 minutes timeframe. AQL: No more than two instances per month per individual when deficiencies requiring corrective action are identified as missed or not corrected by the Contractor.	Incentive: CPARS, Option Exercise.
4.4.2	VATAS Employee Profile Updates	Standard: Verify the VATAS Employee Profile against the Payroll system are correct within a 30- minute timeframe. Create/maintain temporary employee profile accounts within a 30-minute timeframe Based on verification requirements, prioritize case in appropriate time received, and work cases within a 30-minute timeframe. AQL: No more than two instances per month per individual when deficiencies requiring corrective action are identified as missed or not corrected by the Contractor.	Incentive: Past Performance Evaluation
4.4.2	VATAS Activate/Deactivate Employee Profile	Standard: Activate/de-active employee in the Payroll system within 30-minutes of verification requirement. AQL: No more than two instances per month per individual when deficiencies requiring corrective action are identified as missed or not corrected by the Contractor.	Incentive: CPARS, Option Exercise.
4.4.2	VATAS Validation Overrides	Standard: Perform Timesheet Validation Overrides within a 30-minutes of verification of overrides. AQL: No more than two instances per month when deficiencies requiring corrective action are identified as missed or not corrected by the Contractor.	Incentive: CPARS, Option Exercise.
4.4.2	VATAS Tour of Duty (TOD) Unit Maintenance	Standard: Assign TOD Units to appropriate Station and/or Duty Station within a 30-minutes of being received. AQL: No more than two instances per month when deficiencies requiring corrective action are identified as missed or not corrected by the Contractor.	Incentive: CPARS, Option Exercise.

4.4.2	VATAS Timesheets and Reports	Standard: Gather/provide Timesheet History within three business days of requesting Station or Duty Station. Gather/provide VATAS Reports within three business days of requesting Station or Duty Station AQL: No more than two instances per month when deficiencies requiring corrective action are identified as missed or not corrected by the Contractor.	Incentive: CPARS, Option Exercise.
4.4.2	VATAS Payroll Assessments and Validations	Standard: Worked in accordance with established guidelines & timeframe determined at the beginning of the tasking AQL: No more than two instances per month when deficiencies requiring corrective action are identified as missed or not corrected by the Contractor.	Incentive: CPARS, Option Exercise.
4.5.1	Optional Tasks 1a Surge Support for 4.2 (CECD)	Standard: Appropriate staffing to meet surge support AQL: No more than a month to meet staffing requirements.	Incentive: CPARS, Option Exercise.
4.5.2	Optional Tasks 1b Surge Support for (VATAS)	Standard: Appropriate staffing to meet surge support AQL: No more than a month to meet staffing requirements.	Incentive: CPARS, Option Exercise.
4.6.1	Optional Task 2 Incoming Transition Plan	Standard: The Contractor shall perform all incoming transition activities necessary to assume full operational control without service disruption. This includes onboarding personnel, obtaining system access, receiving documentation, completing knowledge transfer sessions, and validating operational readiness. AQL The Contractor must complete at least 95% of incoming transition tasks on time and in accordance with approved procedures, with no more than 5% requiring rework or follow-up.	Incentive: CPARS, Option Exercise.
4.6.2	Outgoing Transition plan	Standard The Contractor shall support an organized and cooperative outgoing transition to the successor Contractor or Government. This includes transferring documentation, systems information, knowledge, access credentials, inventories, and all Government-owned property while maintaining uninterrupted	Incentive: CPARS, Option Exercise.

		services until the official transition end date. AQL The Contractor must maintain a minimum of 95% compliance with all outgoing transition requirements, ensuring timely transfer of materials, complete documentation, and full cooperation with Government direction and successor personnel.	
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The Government will use the methods outlined in the QASP, below to perform surveillance of the Contractor performance:

6.3. Methods of Surveillance

1. Various methods exist to monitor performance. The COR shall use any or a combination of the surveillance methods listed below in assessing performance using this QASP.
2. 100% INSPECTION. (Evaluates all outcomes to include tasks and deliverables.)
Each month, the COR shall review Incentive: Incentive: CPARS, Option Exercise.
the Contractor's performance/generated documentation and document the results accordingly. This assessment shall be placed in the COR's QA file.
3. 100% INSPECTION (of a Specific type of Deliverable) in a Specific Area or Task
Each month, the COR shall review the Contractor's performance/generated documentation and document the results accordingly. This assessment shall be placed in the COR's QA file.
4. Random Sample: Each month, the COR shall review a random sampling of the Contractor's performance/generated documentation and document the results accordingly. This assessment shall be placed in the COR's QA file.
5. Validated Customer Complaint or Validated Below Average Acceptable Quality Level of Performance (AQL) in a Specific Area: Each month, the COR shall review the Contractor's performance/generated documentation corresponding to a validated customer complaint or validated inability to perform in accordance with the AQL in a specific area and document the results accordingly. This assessment shall be placed in the COR's QA file.
6. On-Site Surveillance: Each quarter, the COR shall review and document findings from an on-site surveillance and document the results accordingly. This assessment shall be placed in the COR's QA file.

6.4. Documenting Performance

Poor performance may result in the issuance of a Disciplinary Action In Accordance with Federal Acquisition Regulations (FAR). The Contractor's performance on this TO will be reported to the Contractor Performance Assessment Reporting System (CPARS) on an annual basis. The CO and

COR will make use of information, as well as any additional knowledge and information available to them with respect to the Contractor's performance, to complete the CPARS.

The Government will not pay for services that do not conform or do not meet performance standards or have not been properly rendered. The Contractor will be given an opportunity to correct non-conforming services at no cost to the Government if the services are non-conforming or the contract requirement is unacceptable.

Acceptable Performance

The Government shall document acceptable performance in accordance with the chart above. Any report may become a part of the supporting documentation for any contractual action.

Unacceptable Performance

When unacceptable performance occurs, the COR shall inform the CO. This will always be in writing although when circumstances necessitate immediate verbal communication, that communication will be followed in writing. The COR shall document the discussion and place it in the COR file.

When the CO determines formal written communication is required, the COR shall prepare a Contract Discrepancy Report (CDR) and present it to the Contractor's program manager.

The Contractor shall acknowledge receipt of the CDR in writing to the CO. The CDR will state how long after receipt the Contractor must take corrective action. The CDR will also specify if the Contractor is required to prepare a corrective action plan to document how the Contractor shall correct the unacceptable performance and avoid a recurrence. The CO shall review the Contractor's corrective action plan to determine acceptability.

7.0 PERIOD OF PERFORMANCE

The anticipated periods of performance (PoP) are as follows:

Base Period: Effective Date of Award through 12 Months of Performance

Option Period 1: If Exercised, 12 Months of Performance from Effective Date of Option Exercise

Option Period 2: If Exercised, 12 Months of Performance from Effective Date of Option Exercise

Option Period 3: If Exercised, 12 Months of Performance from Effective Date of Option Exercise

Option Period 4: If Exercised, 12 Months of Performance from Effective Date of Option Exercise

Should FAR Clause 52.217-8 be exercised, it will be in accordance with FAR regulation with a Period of Performance of up to six (6) months of performance.

7.1. Hours of Operations

The Contractor shall observe the hours of operation as shown in Table Financial Services Help Desk Hours of Operation and Coverage. The Contractor shall provide Help Desk services Monday through Friday, Central Time. The Contractors shall ensure adequate manning level during operational hours and must support high volume calls during peak hours between 10:00 am to 3:00 pm.

7.2. Tour of Duty:

The Contractor shall ensure that each CSR shall work a full eight (8) hour shift per day during operational hours. The Contractor shall ensure sufficient staffing to meet all required service levels without the use of overtime. No overtime labor will be authorized or reimbursed under this contract.

7.3. Call Handling Cutoff:

The Contractor shall ensure that Customer Service Representatives do not accept new calls or cases within the last 30 minutes of their scheduled shift, allowing sufficient time to complete active calls and administrative tasks without exceeding the eight (8) hour workday.

Financial Services Help Desk Hours of Operation and Coverage		
	Hours of Operation	
	Beginning Time	Ending Time
Customer Engagement Center	7:15 AM	4:15 PM
VATAS Help Desk Services	7:00 AM	7:00 PM
NOTE: All times are in Central Time (zone).		

7.4. Observance Of Government Holidays

There are 11 Federal holidays set by law (USC Title 5 Section 6103). Under current definitions, five are set by date:

<i>New Year's Day</i>	January 1
<i>Juneteenth</i>	June 19
<i>Independence Day</i>	July 4
<i>Veterans Day</i>	November 11
<i>Christmas Day</i>	December 25

If any of the above falls on a Saturday, then Friday shall be observed as a holiday. Similarly, if one falls on a Sunday, then Monday shall be observed as a holiday. The other six holidays are set by a day of the week and month:

<i>Martin Luther King's Birthday</i>	Third Monday in January
<i>Washington's Birthday</i>	Third Monday in February
<i>Memorial Day</i>	Last Monday in May
<i>Labor Day</i>	First Monday in September
<i>Columbus Day</i>	Second Monday in October
<i>Thanksgiving</i>	Fourth Thursday in November

7.5. Weekend Observation Rule:

Please note when a holiday falls on a nonwork day - Saturday or Sunday - the holiday usually is observed on Monday (if the holiday falls on Sunday) or Friday (if the holiday falls on Saturday).

7.6. Inclusion of Executive Order Holidays:

Any additional days declared federal holidays by Executive Order or Presidential Proclamation—such as Christmas Eve or other designated days—shall also be observed for pay and leave purposes. When such days fall on weekends, the same Saturday/Friday and Sunday/Monday substitution rule applies.

8.0 PLACE OF PERFORMANCE

8.1. Primary Place of Performance

The primary place of performance will primarily be performed on-site at the VA Financial Services Center (FSC) located in Austin, Texas. However, due to ongoing construction and return-to-office challenges, the Government has authorized Full time remote work. The Government reserves the right to require Contractor personnel to report on-site at any time during the period of performance.

Contractor personnel utilizing telework shall complete:

- Certification of the Contractor's successful completion of initial training requirements.
- Certification of the Contractor's successful completion of telework (telecommuting) training including the VA security and privacy training.

8.2. Revoke Telework

The Government reserves the right to modify or revoke Contractor telework arrangements at any time, with or without prior notice, based on operational needs, performance requirements, security considerations, or any other determination made in the best interest of the Government. The Contractor shall ensure that all personnel are capable of reporting onsite within the timeframe specified by the Government (30 business days) and shall maintain staffing levels and continuity of operations regardless of telework status. Any changes to telework eligibility shall not relieve the Contractor of meeting all performance standards, service levels, or contractual obligations.

8.3. Report Onsite

The Government will provide the Contractor with at least 30 business days' notice prior to requiring personnel to report on-site, unless an urgent operational need requires a shorter notice period. When on-site work is required, the Contractor shall ensure personnel report to the designated location as directed by the Government.

9.0 TRAVEL

There is no official travel anticipated, nor is it expected during the period of performance. Local travel within 50 miles of workstation or Government facility is not reimbursed. Contractor employees within a 50-mile radius of the FSC may be required to go to the FSC office in Austin, TX to obtain Personal Identity Verification (PIV) badges and/or Government Furnished Equipment (GFE). There shall be no additional cost to the Government for travel or labor rates associated with remote work or attendance at required on-site activities.

10.0 MATERIAL OTHER DIRECT COSTS

Not anticipated for this requirement.

11.0 GOVERNMENT-FURNISHED INFORMATION, EQUIPMENT, AND PROPERTY (GFE/GFI/GFP)

The Contractor's Key Personnel will be issued a Personal Identity Verification (PIV) card to allow access to VA platforms. The Contractor's Key Personnel will be given Remote Access into the VA system. All personnel obtaining GFE/GFI/GFP shall complete IT Security Requirements and complete Rules of Behavior (ROB) (Attachment TBD) form and have completed all required security training. GFE/GFI/GFP will be strictly provided only as necessary and approved by the Government. The Contractor shall be required to complete a GFI/GFE/GFP form as requested by the COR when requiring GFE/GFI/GFP.

The Contractor's Key Personnel may be issued Government furnished equipment (desktop, laptop, mobile phone, etc.). It is not intended that all staff receive GFE. Only those with a critical need outside of Key Personnel may be considered for furnishing GFE and must be fully justified as to the criticality as to the nature of the request. All issuance of (GFE/GFI/GFP) will be coordinated and filled with an Austin TX, VA-FSC Inventory Management team. The Austin, TX VA FSC is the only authorized location for issuing (GFE/GFI/GFP) to the contractor. No other VA facility is permitted to issue GFE. If the Contractor is located within a 50-mile radius of the VA FSC, the Contractor shall pick up the GFE in person. If outside this radius, the Contractor shall coordinate shipment with the VA FSC. The Contractor is responsible for coordinating with the VA FSC Inventory Management Team to schedule issuance, obtain pickup instructions, or receive shipping materials and guidance as applicable.

The Contractor shall only use Government IT equipment for purposes specifically tied to or authorized by the contract and in accordance with VA-FSC policy. The Government's issuance of Government Furnished Equipment (GFE) is limited to Contractor personnel requiring the Contractor to access VA networks, systems, or applications to meet the requirements of this PWS.

GFE will be coordinated and requested by the contract Project Manager / Contractor Team Lead prior to issuance for use by the Contractor. Only the VA-FSC Austin Location / Inventory Management Team will issue GFE to the Contractors to include initial GFE issuance and equipment replacement. All issuance and reclamation of GFE will be coordinated with the VA-FSC Inventory Management team. The overarching goal is to determine the most cost-effective approach to providing needed access to the VA environment coupled with the need to ensure proper inventory management principles are followed.

Contractor personnel shall adhere to all VA system access requirements for on-site and remote users in accordance with VA standards, local security regulations, policies, and rules of behavior.

11.1. Estimated GFE Provision for Contractor Personnel

Based upon the Government assessment of remote access solutions and requirements of this effort, the Government estimates that the following GFE will be required by this effort:

- One (1) monitor and one (1) laptop per Contractor supporting section 4.0.
- The Government anticipates supply of no more than 100 monitors and 100 laptops total.

11.2. Additional IT accessories

The Government will not provide IT accessories including but not limited to Mobile Wi-Fi hotspots/wireless access points, extra or specialized keyboards or mice, extra charging cables, extra PIV card readers, peripheral devices, or additional Random Access Memory (RAM). The Contractor is responsible for providing these types of additional IT accessories in support of this effort as necessary and any VA installation required for these IT accessories shall be coordinated with the COR.

11.3. GFI/GFE/GFP Reclamation

GFE/GFI/GFP issued will be tracked over the life of the effort by the COR. Final Invoice shall be withheld until all GFE/GFI/GFP has been retrieved and/or otherwise final dispensation of GFE/GFI/GFP is approved by COR and CO upon completion of the Contract. Contractor is responsible for all return of GFE/GFI/GFP collection and return, and/or returns of PIV Cards or other equipment to be returned to the source from where it was originally provided. Failure to return GFI/GFP/GFP upon completion of contract or as otherwise requested by Government is cause for providing negative CPARS rating and other disciplinary action as allowed by Federal Regulations.

Any changes to GFE/GFI/GFP assignment to employees shall be initiated with the COR and with no less than 2 days' notification. No GFE/GFI/GFP assignments shall be changed without a minimum of business days' notice and approval of the COR. All changes in status will be noted on Government GFE/GFI/GFP log, as maintained by the COR.

The Contractor shall ensure that all GFI/GFE/GFP is returned in good working condition, accounting for normal wear and tear. The Contractor shall coordinate with the Contracting Officer's Representative (COR) to schedule the return of GFE/GFI/GFP and shall provide an inventory reconciliation report confirming all items have been returned. Any missing, damaged, or non-functional equipment beyond normal wear and tear, shall be documented and reported immediately to the COR. Contractor shall be responsible for damage (other than through normal wear and tear), theft or loss of GFE/GFI/GFP. Remedies will be in accordance with Federal Acquisition Regulations (FAR) and may be noted as part of CPARS.

The Government shall bear all costs associated with the return of GFE, including shipping, handling, and insurance, unless otherwise authorized by the Government. Failure to return GFE in accordance with these requirements may result in withholding of final payment or other remedies as determined by Federal Acquisition Regulations and/or by the Contracting Officer (CO).

11.4. GFE/GFI/GFP Reporting

The Contractor shall provide the status of all reportable GFE/GFI/GFP as part of the Monthly Progress Report in section 4.1.6. For purposes of this report, reportable GFE includes equipment that is furnished by the Government as tangible "personal" property which the Contractor takes possession of, physically leaves a Government facility, and needs to be returned the end of Contractor performance.

The following information shall be provided for each piece of GFE:

- Name of Contractor employee assigned to the GFE
- Type of Equipment (Make and Model)
- Tracking Number/Serial Number
- VA Bar Code
- Location
- Value
- Total Value of Equipment
- Anticipated Transfer Date back to Government

12.0 CHANGES TO THE PWS

Any changes to this PWS shall be authorized and approved only through written correspondence from the CO and modification to the Contract if applicable. A copy of each change will be kept in a contract folder, along with all other products of the contract. The COR has no authority to bind the Government or authority to make material changes to the contract.

13.0 KEY PERSONNEL

The Contractor will designate the minimum personnel that will be considered key personnel and be assigned to this contract. The Contractor shall propose appropriate labor categories for these positions. Key personnel must be assigned for the duration of the contract. The Contractor shall identify all key personnel, if applicable, in the price proposal. The Contractor shall assign key personnel whose names were identified in the quote and who are integral to the performance of the contract requirements. It is the responsibility of the Contractor to provide Contractor support personnel and subcontractors who have the required educational background, experience, security clearance, and access authorization or combination thereof to meet the labor category descriptions under this task order for the required PWS tasks. The Contractor shall represent/acknowledge that all personnel assigned to the contract are capable of working independently and with demonstrated knowledge, skills and expertise in their respective functional areas, which are necessary to perform all assigned duties. If the Contractor personnel do not possess the expertise necessary to perform the tasks required under this contract, then the contractor shall be responsible for the appropriate training and/or replacing the personnel. The customer will require replacement of key personnel if staff are not meeting expectations.

The following Key Personnel are required for performance under this Contract/Order:

PWS Section	Task	Role Summary	Minimum Qualifications
4.1	Program Management	Provide comprehensive Project Management for the duration of the contract, serving as the primary point of contact with the Government and overseeing the overall management, coordination, and execution of all tasks under the PWS	Bachelor's degree or equivalent - Minimum 3 years of experience in customer service/help desk operations - At least 1 year of supervisory or lead experience - Familiarity with systems and compliance requirements
4.2.2; 4.2.3, 4.3.2	Customer Service Representative – Core Services	Provides intermediate-level customer service and administrative support for financial operations and payroll systems. Handles complex inquiries requiring knowledge of VA processes and systems.	- High school diploma or equivalent - Minimum 1 year of experience in customer service/help desk support - Proficiency in Microsoft Office - Ability to interpret policies and procedures
4.2.1 & 4.3.1	Customer Service Representative – Lead	Serves as a team lead, responsible for oversight, coordination, and quality assurance of CSR staff. Ensure compliance with performance standards and support operational management.	- High school diploma or equivalent - Minimum 3 years of experience in customer service/help desk operations - At least 1 years of supervisory or lead experience - Familiarity with systems and compliance requirements

The Contractor shall not substitute key personnel during the contract performance period unless the substitutions are unavoidable because of the incumbent's sudden illness, death or termination of employment or the customer requires replacement of the key personnel. The Contractor shall promptly notify the customer if this is the case. The Contractor shall submit to the customer all proposed substitutions at least 30 days in advance. Requests must contain a complete resume for the proposed substitute who shall have at least equal ability and qualifications and receive approval from the customer.

14.0 SPECIAL REQUIREMENTS

14.1. Records Management

Applicable records management laws and regulations:

The Contractor shall comply with all applicable records management laws and regulations, as well as National Archives and Records Administration (NARA) records policies, including but not limited to the Federal Records Act (44 U.S.C. chs. 21, 29, 31, 33), NARA regulations at 36 CFR Chapter XII Subchapter B, and those policies associated with the safeguarding of records covered by the Privacy

Act of 1974 (5 U.S.C. 552a). These policies include the preservation of all records, regardless of form or characteristics, mode of transmission, or state of completion.

Data created for Government use

In accordance with 36 CFR 1222.32, all data created for Government use and delivered to, or falling under the legal control of, the Government are Federal records subject to the provisions of 44 U.S.C. chapters 21, 29, 31, and 33, the Freedom of Information Act (FOIA) (5 U.S.C. 552), as amended, and the Privacy Act of 1974 (5 U.S.C. 552a), as amended and must be managed and scheduled for disposition only as permitted by statute or regulation.

Managing records

In accordance with 36 CFR 1222.32, Contractor shall maintain all records created for Government use or created while of performing the contract and/or delivered to, or under the legal control of the Government and must be managed in accordance with Federal law. Electronic records and associated metadata must be accompanied by sufficient technical documentation to permit understanding and use of the records and data.

Unauthorized destruction of records

VA-FSC and its Contractors are responsible for preventing the alienation or unauthorized destruction of records, including all forms of mutilation. Records may not be removed from the legal custody of VA-FSC or destroyed except for in accordance with the provisions of the agency records schedules and with the written concurrence of the Head of the Contracting Activity. Willful and unlawful destruction, damage or alienation of Federal records is subject to the fines and penalties imposed by 18 U.S.C. 2701. In the event of any unlawful or accidental removal, defacing, alteration, or destruction of records, Contractor must report to VA-FSC. The agency must report promptly to NARA in accordance with 36 CFR 1230.

Inadvertent or unauthorized disclosures of information

The Contractor shall immediately notify the appropriate Contracting Officer upon discovery of any inadvertent or unauthorized disclosures of information, data, documentary materials, records or equipment. Disclosure of non-public information is limited to authorized personnel with a need-to-know as described in the [contract vehicle]. The Contractor shall ensure that the appropriate personnel, administrative, technical, and physical safeguards are established to ensure the security and confidentiality of this information, data, documentary material, records and/or equipment are properly protected. The Contractor shall not remove material from Government facilities or systems, or facilities or systems operated or maintained on the Government's behalf, without the express written permission of the Head of the Contracting Activity. When information, data, documentary material, records and/or equipment is no longer required, it shall be returned to VA-FSC control, or the Contractor must hold it until otherwise directed. Items returned to the Government shall be hand carried, mailed, emailed, or securely electronically transmitted to the Contracting Officer. Destruction of records is EXPRESSLY PROHIBITED unless in accordance with Paragraph (1.4).

Subcontracting and Information Disclosure Requirements

The Contractor is required to obtain the Contracting Officer's approval prior to engaging in any contractual relationship (sub-Contractor) in support of this contract requiring the disclosure of information, documentary material and/or records generated under, or relating to, contracts. The Contractor (and any sub-Contractor) is required to abide by Government and VA-FSC guidance for protecting sensitive, proprietary information, classified, and controlled unclassified information.

Maintaining non-public VA-FSC information

The Contractor shall not create or maintain any records containing any non-public VA-FSC information that are not specifically tied to or authorized by the contract.

Retain, use, sell, or disseminate of copies

The Contractor shall not retain, use, sell, or disseminate copies of any deliverable that contains information covered by the Privacy Act of 1974 or that which is generally protected from public disclosure by an exemption to the Freedom of Information Act.

Data rights

The VA-FSC owns the rights to all data and records produced as part of this contract. All deliverables under the contract are the property of the U.S. Government for which VA-FSC shall have unlimited rights to use, dispose of, or disclose such data contained therein as it determines to be in the public interest. Any Contractor rights in the data or deliverables must be identified as required by FAR 52.227-11 through FAR 52.227-20.

Records Management Training

All Contractor employees assigned to this contract who create, work with, or otherwise handle records are required to take VA-FSC provided records management training. The Contractor is responsible for confirming training has been completed according to agency policies, including initial training and any annual or refresher training.

14.2. Continuity of Operations Plan (COOP)

The purpose of the COOP is to ensure the FSC can conduct its mission and essential functions under all threats, hazards and conditions. To ensure its operations are performed efficiently and with minimal disruption, telework will be used to the maximum extent possible to provide this redundancy/flexibility. To this end, the following requirements apply:

The Contractor shall use Government furnished equipment (GFE) during telework, on an as needed or emergency basis. GFE includes monitor, desktop or laptop.

Contractor staff who telework on an occasional basis may be subjected to increased or 100% telework during a continuity event based on operational need.

Should the Government be required to implement its COOP, Contractor personnel may be required to report to the VA FSC Disaster Recovery site to perform normal duties. The VA FSC Disaster Recovery site will be identified by the COR and will be followed-up with a modification to the contract.

On a day when the official duty station facility is closed for all or part of the day, the Contractor will be required to perform work at the alternate work site as specified in the Contractor's written telework

agreement. The Contractor shall utilize a Telework Request/Agreement which states that the Contractor is expected to telework for the duration of an emergency pursuant to a pandemic and/or when the traditional worksite/official duty station is closed due to emergency situations (e.g., snow emergencies, floods, hurricanes, act of terrorism).

All Contractors are responsible for understanding the Continuity of Operations Plans (COOP) and VA-required emergency actions to include:

Demonstrating proficiency through performance of relevant emergency and continuity procedures and the ability to explain to others what steps to take should an emergency occur.

Continuity of Operations Plans (COOP) Training

Participate in training and exercises on emergency procedures, as appropriate

Emergency Alerting and Accountability System (EAAS)

To remain available during emergencies for critical work-related tasks, each employee should plan appropriate steps to ensure personal and family preparedness for any emergency situations occurring in their home communities; and Complete registration and updates in Emergency Alerting and Accountability System (EAAS) as appropriate.

The Contractor shall provide, at a minimum, the following information for personnel accountability:

- Work location address.
- Work number
- Government-issued cellular telephone number
- Government e-mail
- Personal off-duty contact number (home or cell phone number—this is critical for non-work hour contact and coordination)
- Permanent home address

15.0 IT/SECURITY REQUIREMENTS

Contractors, Contractor personnel, subContractors, and subContractor personnel shall be subject to the same Federal laws, regulations, standards, and VA Directives and Handbooks as VA and VA personnel regarding information and information system security.

15.1. Position/Task Risk Delegation Level(S)

Position/Task Risk Delegation Level(s): The Contractor shall ensure that all personnel assigned under this contract meet the minimum Position Risk Designation and suitability requirements established by the Government. The Government will determine the appropriate risk level (e.g., Low Risk, Moderate Risk, or High-Risk Public Trust) for each position based on the duties performed, access requirements, and sensitivity of information handled. The Contractor shall provide only personnel who have received the required background investigations, adjudications, and credentialing necessary for the delegated risk level. The Government reserves the right to adjust Position Risk Designations at any time based on mission needs, system access changes, or evolving security considerations, and the Contractor shall comply with all updated requirements without interruption to performance.

Position Sensitivity	Background Investigation (in accordance with Department of Veterans Affairs 0710 Handbook, "Personnel Suitability and Security Program," Appendix A)
Low / Tier 1	Tier 1 / National Agency Check with Written Inquiries (NACI) A Tier 1/NACI is conducted by OPM and covers a 5-year period. It consists of a review of records contained in the OPM Security Investigations Index (SII) and the DOD Defense Central Investigations Index (DCII), Federal Bureau of Investigation (FBI) name check, FBI fingerprint check, and written inquiries to previous employers and references listed on the application for employment. In VA it is used for Non-sensitive or Low Risk positions.
Moderate / Tier 2	Tier 2 / Moderate Background Investigation (MBI) A Tier 2/MBI is conducted by OPM and covers a 5-year period. It consists of a review of National Agency Check (NAC) records [OPM Security Investigations Index (SII), DOD Defense Central Investigations Index (DCII), FBI name check, and a FBI fingerprint check], a credit report covering a period of 5 years, written inquiries to previous employers and references listed on the application for employment; an interview with the subject, law enforcement check; and a verification of the educational degree.
High / Tier 4	Tier 4 / Background Investigation (BI) A Tier 4/BI is conducted by OPM and covers a 10-year period. It consists of a review of National Agency Check (NAC) records [OPM Security Investigations Index (SII), DOD Defense Central Investigations Index (DCII), FBI name check, and a FBI fingerprint check report], a credit report covering a period of 10 years, written inquiries to previous employers and references listed on the application for employment; an interview with the subject, spouse, neighbors, supervisor, co-workers; court records, law enforcement check, and a verification of the educational degree.
Position Sensitivity	Background Investigation (in accordance with Department of Veterans Affairs 0710 Handbook, "Personnel Suitability and Security Program," Appendix A)
Low / Tier 1	Tier 1 / National Agency Check with Written Inquiries (NACI) A Tier 1/NACI is conducted by OPM and covers a 5-year period. It consists of a review of records contained in the OPM Security Investigations Index (SII) and the DOD Defense Central Investigations Index (DCII), Federal Bureau of Investigation (FBI) name check, FBI fingerprint check, and written inquiries to previous employers and references listed on the application for employment. In VA it is used for Non-sensitive or Low Risk positions.
Moderate / Tier 2	Tier 2 / Moderate Background Investigation (MBI) A Tier 2/MBI is conducted by OPM and covers a 5-year period. It consists of a review of National Agency Check (NAC) records [OPM Security Investigations Index (SII), DOD Defense Central Investigations Index (DCII), FBI name check, and a FBI fingerprint check], a credit report covering a period of 5 years, written inquiries to previous employers and references listed on the application for employment; an interview with the subject, law enforcement check; and a verification of the educational degree.
High / Tier 4	Tier 4 / Background Investigation (BI) A Tier 4/BI is conducted by OPM and covers a 10-year period. It consists of a review of National Agency Check (NAC) records [OPM Security Investigations Index (SII), DOD Defense Central Investigations Index (DCII), FBI name check, and a FBI fingerprint check report], a credit report covering a period of 10 years, written inquiries to previous employers and references listed on the application for employment; an interview with the subject, spouse, neighbors, supervisor, co-workers; court records, law enforcement check, and a verification of the educational degree.

The Tasks identified above, and the resulting Position Sensitivity and Background Investigation requirements identify, in effect, the Background Investigation requirements for Contractor individuals, based upon the tasks the Contractor individual will be working. The submitted Contractor Staff Roster must indicate the required Background Investigation Level for each Contractor individual based upon the tasks the Contractor individual will be working, in accordance with their submitted proposal.

15.2. Remote Access

The Government has multiple remote access solutions available to include Citrix Access Gateway (CAG), Site-to-Site Virtual Private Network (VPN), and RESCUE VPN.

15.3. ACCESS TO VA INFORMATION AND VA INFORMATION SYSTEMS

A Contractor/subContractor shall request logical (technical) or physical access to VA information and VA information systems for their employees, subContractors, and affiliates only to the extent necessary to perform the services specified in the contract, agreement, or task order.

a. All Contractors, subContractors, and third-party servicers and associates working with VA information are subject to the same investigative requirements as those of VA appointees or employees who have access to the same types of information. The level and process of background security investigations for Contractors must be in accordance with VA Directive and Handbook 0710, *Personnel Suitability and Security Program*. The Office for Operations, Security, and Preparedness is responsible for these policies and procedures.

b. Contract personnel who require access to national security programs must have a valid security clearance. National Industrial Security Program (NISP) was established by Executive Order 12829 to ensure that cleared U.S. defense industry contract personnel safeguard the classified information in their possession while performing work on contracts, programs, bids, or research and development efforts. The Department of Veterans Affairs does not have a Memorandum of Agreement with Defense Security Service (DSS). Verification of a Security Clearance must be processed through the Special Security Officer located in the Planning and National Security Service within the Office of Operations, Security, and Preparedness.

c. Custom software development and outsourced operations must be located in the U.S. to the maximum extent practical. If such services are proposed to be performed abroad and are not disallowed by other VA policy or mandates, the Contractor/subContractor must state where all non-U.S. services are provided and detail a security plan, deemed to be acceptable by VA, specifically to address mitigation of the resulting problems of communication, control, data protection, and so forth. Location within the U.S. may be an evaluation factor.

d. The Contractor or subContractor must notify the Contracting Officer immediately when an employee working on a VA system or with access to VA information is reassigned or leaves the Contractor or subContractor's employ. The Contracting Officer must also be notified immediately by the Contractor or subContractor prior to an unfriendly termination.

15.4 VA INFORMATION CUSTODIAL LANGUAGE

a. Information made available to the Contractor or subContractor by VA for the performance or administration of this contract or information developed by the Contractor/subContractor in performance or administration of the contract shall be used only for those purposes and shall not be used in any other way without the prior written agreement of

the VA. This clause expressly limits the Contractor/subContractor's rights to use data as described in Rights in Data- General, FAR 52.227-14(d)1(1).

b. VA information should not be co-mingled, if possible, with any other data on the Contractors/subContractor's information systems or media storage systems in order to ensure VA requirements related to data protection and media sanitization can be met. If co-mingling must be allowed to meet the requirements of the business need, the Contractor must ensure that VA's information is returned to the VA or destroyed in accordance with VA's sanitization requirements. VA reserves the right to conduct onsite inspections of Contractor and subContractor IT resources to ensure data security controls, separation of data and job duties, and destruction/media sanitization procedures are in compliance with VA directive requirements.

c. Prior to termination or completion of this contract, Contractor/subContractor must not destroy information received from VA, or gathered/created by the Contractor in the course of performing this contract without prior written approval by the VA. Any data destruction done on behalf of VA by a Contractor/subContractor must be done in accordance with National Archives and Records Administration (NARA) requirements as outlined in VA Directive 6300, *Records and Information Management* and its Handbook 6300.1 *Records Management Procedures*, applicable VA Records Control Schedules, and VA Handbook 6500.1, *Electronic Media Sanitization*. Self-certification by the Contractor that the data destruction requirements above have been met must be sent to the VA Contracting Officer within 30 days of termination of the contract.

d. The Contractor/subContractor must receive, gather, store, back up, maintain, use, disclose and dispose of VA information only in compliance with the terms of the contract and applicable Federal and VA information confidentiality and security laws, regulations and policies. If Federal or VA information confidentiality and security laws, regulations and policies become applicable to the VA information or information systems after execution of the contract, or if NIST issues or updates applicable FIPS or Special Publications (SP) after execution of this contract, the parties agree to negotiate in good faith to implement the information confidentiality and security laws, regulations and policies in this contract.

e. The Contractor/subContractor shall not make copies of VA information except as authorized and necessary to perform the terms of the agreement or to preserve electronic information stored on Contractor/subContractor electronic storage media for restoration in case any electronic equipment or data used by the Contractor/SubContractor needs to be restored to an operating state. If copies are made for restoration purposes, after the restoration is complete, the copies must be appropriately destroyed.

f. If VA determines that the Contractor has violated any of the information confidentiality, privacy, and security provisions of the contract, it shall be sufficient grounds for VA to withhold payment to the Contractor or third party or terminate the contract for default or terminate for cause under Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) part 12.

g. If a VHA contract is terminated for cause, the associated BAA must also be

terminated and appropriate actions taken in accordance with VHA Handbook 1600.01, *Business Associate Agreements*. Absent an agreement to use or disclose protected health information, there is no business associate relationship.

h. The Contractor/subContractor must store, transport, or transmit VA sensitive information in an encrypted form, using VA-approved encryption tools that are, at a minimum, FIPS 140-2 validated.

i. The Contractor/subContractor's firewall and Web services security controls, if applicable, shall meet or exceed VA's minimum requirements. VA Configuration Guidelines are available upon request.

j. Except for uses and disclosures of VA information authorized by this contract for performance of the contract, the Contractor/subContractor may use and disclose VA information only in two other situations: (i) in response to a qualifying order of a court of competent jurisdiction, or (ii) with VA's prior written approval. The Contractor/subContractor must refer all requests for demands for production of, or inquiries about, VA information and information systems to the VA contracting officer for response.

k. Notwithstanding the provision above, the Contractor/subContractor shall not release VA records protected by Title 38 U.S.C. 5705, confidentiality of medical quality assurance records and/or Title 38 U.S.C. 7332, confidentiality of certain health records pertaining to drug addiction, sickle cell anemia, alcoholism or alcohol abuse, or infection with human immunodeficiency virus. If the Contractor/subContractor is in receipt of a court order or other requests for the above-mentioned information, that Contractor/subContractor shall immediately refer such court orders or other requests to the VA contracting officer for response.

l. For service that involves the storage, generating, transmitting, or exchanging of VA sensitive information but does not require C&A or an MOU-ISA for system interconnection, the Contractor/subContractor must complete a Contractor Security Control Assessment (CSCA) on a yearly basis and provide it to the COTR.

15.5. VA Sensitive Information

In accordance with VA policy, contractors' storage, generation, transmission or exchanging of VA sensitive information requires appropriate security controls to be in place. The VA Information Security Program policy – VA Directive and Handbook 6500 and additional 6500 series directives and handbooks - provide the framework for security within VA.

This Contract will require access to VA sensitive information. Personnel supporting this contract will perform a function that requires access to a VA system or VA sensitive information (e.g., system administrator privileged access to a VA system, or Contractor systems or processes that utilize VA sensitive information).

The 6500.6 appendix (A) must be completed at the initiation of all IT service acquisitions, statements of work, third-party service agreements and any other legally binding agreement in order to determine what, if any, security and privacy controls are necessary specifically as it relates to the VAAR security clause. OGC guidance will be sought on data ownership issues, as necessary. Reference the 6500.6 appendix (A) and procedures outlined in VA Directive 6500, Information Security Program; and VA Handbook 6500.6, Contract Security.

VA will supply the Contractor with the minimum logical (technical) and/or physical access to VA information and VA information systems for employees, sub-contractors: (1) to perform the services specified in the contract, (2) to perform necessary maintenance functions for electronic storage or transmission media necessary for performance of the contract, and (3) for individuals who first satisfy the same conditions, requirements, and restrictions that comparable VA employees must meet to have access to the same type of VA information.

All Contractors and subcontractors working with VA Sensitive Information are subject to the same investigative requirements as those of regular VA appointees or employees who have access to the same types of information. The level of background security investigation will be in accordance with VA Directive 0710, Handbook 0710, which are available at: <http://www1.va.gov/vapubs>, and VHA Directive 0710 and Implementation Handbook 0710.01, which are available at: <http://www1.va.gov/vhapublications/index.cfm>. Contractors are responsible for screening their employees.

The following are VA's approved policy exceptions for meeting VA background screenings/investigative requirements for certain types of Contractor personnel:

- Contractor personnel which are not accessing VA information resources, such as personnel hired to maintain the medical facility grounds, construction contracts, utility system contractors, etc.
- Contractor personnel with limited and intermittent access to equipment connected to networks on which no VA sensitive information resides.
- Contractor personnel with limited and intermittent access to equipment connected to networks on which limited VA sensitive information resides and with limited and intermittent access to facilities at which they are escorted.

15.6. Privacy Requirements, Confidentiality, And Nondisclosure

Information provided by the Government shall be used solely for contract performance and not for any other purpose without prior written approval from the Contracting Officer (CO).

The Contractor is responsible for protecting the confidentiality of all non-public records. Each employee shall be notified in writing that disclosure is limited to authorized purposes.

All deliverables, working papers, and related materials generated under this contract are the exclusive property of the U.S. Government and must be submitted to the CO at contract completion.

The CO is the sole authority to release any data or materials related to this contract. Contractors shall not release information or respond to external requests; all inquiries must be referred to the CO. Press releases, marketing materials, or any other documentation related to this project shall not be publicized without written approval from the CO.

15.7. Security Incident Investigation

- a. The term “security incident” means an event that has, or could have, resulted in unauthorized access to, loss or damage to VA assets, or sensitive information, or an action that breaches VA security procedures. The Contractor/subContractor shall immediately notify the COTR and simultaneously, the designated ISO and Privacy Officer for the contract of any known or suspected security/privacy incidents, or any unauthorized disclosure of sensitive information, including that contained in system(s) to which the Contractor/subContractor has access.
- b. To the extent known by the Contractor/subContractor, the Contractor/subContractor’s notice to VA shall identify the information involved, the circumstances surrounding the incident (including to whom, how, when, and where the VA information or assets were placed at risk or compromised), and any other information that the Contractor/subContractor considers relevant.
- c. With respect to unsecured protected health information, the business associate is deemed to have discovered a data breach when the business associate knew or should have known of a breach of such information. Upon discovery, the business associate must notify the covered entity of the breach. Notifications need to be made in accordance with the executed business associate agreement.
- d. In instances of theft or break-in or other criminal activity, the Contractor/subContractor must concurrently report the incident to the appropriate law enforcement entity (or entities) of jurisdiction, including the VA OIG and Security and Law Enforcement. The Contractor, its employees, and its subContractors and their employees shall cooperate with VA and any law enforcement authority responsible for the investigation and prosecution of any possible criminal law violation(s) associated with any incident. The Contractor/subContractor shall cooperate with VA in any civil litigation to recover VA information, obtain monetary or other compensation from a third party for damages arising from any incident, or obtain injunctive relief against any third party arising from, or related to, the incident.

15.8 Liquidated Damages for Data Breach

- a. Consistent with the requirements of 38 U.S.C. §5725, a contract may require access to sensitive personal information. If so, the Contractor is liable to VA for liquidated damages in the event of a data breach or privacy incident involving any SPI the Contractor/subContractor processes or maintains under this contract.
- b. The Contractor/subContractor shall provide notice to VA of a “security incident” as set forth in the Security Incident Investigation section above. Upon such notification, VA must secure from a non-Department entity or the VA Office of Inspector General an independent risk analysis of the data breach to determine the level of risk associated with the data breach for the potential misuse of any sensitive personal information involved in the data breach. The term 'data breach' means the loss, theft, or other unauthorized access, or any access other than that incidental to the scope of employment, to data containing sensitive personal information, in electronic or printed form, that results in the potential compromise of the confidentiality or integrity of the data. The Contractor shall fully cooperate with the entity performing the risk analysis. Failure to cooperate may be deemed a material breach and grounds for contract termination.

c. Each risk analysis shall address all relevant information concerning the data breach, including the following:

- (1) Nature of the event (loss, theft, unauthorized access);
- (2) Description of the event, including:
 - (a) date of occurrence.
 - (b) data elements involved, including any PII, such as full name, social security number, date of birth, home address, account number, disability code.
- (3) Number of individuals affected or potentially affected.
- (4) Names of individuals or groups affected or potentially affected.
- (5) Ease of logical data access to the lost, stolen or improperly accessed data in light of the degree of protection for the data, e.g., unencrypted, plain text.
- (6) Amount of time the data has been out of VA control.
- (7) The likelihood that the sensitive personal information will or has been compromised (made accessible to and usable by unauthorized persons).
- (8) Known misuses of data containing sensitive personal information, if any.
- (9) Assessment of the potential harm to the affected individuals.
- (10) Data breach analysis as outlined in 6500.2 Handbook, *Management of Security and Privacy Incidents*, as appropriate; and
- (11) Whether credit protection services may assist record subjects in avoiding or mitigating the results of identity theft based on the sensitive personal information that may have been compromised.

d. Based on the determinations of the independent risk analysis, the Contractor shall be responsible for paying to the VA liquidated damages in the amount of \$37.50 per affected individual to cover the cost of providing credit protection services to affected individuals consisting of the following:

- (1) Notification as required.
- (2) One year of credit monitoring services consisting of automatic daily monitoring of at least 3 relevant credit bureau reports.
- (3) Data breach analysis.
- (4) Fraud resolution services, including writing dispute letters, initiating fraud alerts and credit freezes, to assist affected individuals to bring matters to resolution.
- (5) One year of identity theft insurance with \$20,000.00 coverage at \$0 deductible; and
- (6) Necessary legal expenses the subjects may incur to repair falsified or damaged credit records, histories, or financial affairs.

15.9 Security Controls Compliance Testing

On a periodic basis, VA, including the Office of Inspector General, reserves the right to evaluate any or all of the security controls and privacy practices implemented by the Contractor under the clauses contained within the contract. With 10 working-days' notice, at the request of the Government, the Contractor must fully cooperate and assist in a Government-sponsored security controls assessment at each location wherein VA information is processed or stored, or information systems are developed, operated, maintained, or used on behalf of VA, including those initiated by the Office of Inspector General. The Government may conduct a security control assessment on shorter notice (to include unannounced assessments) as determined by VA in the event of a security incident or at any other time.

15.10 Training

a. All Contractor employees and subContractor employees requiring access to VA information and VA information systems shall complete the following before being granted access to VA information and its systems:

- (1) Sign and acknowledge (either manually or electronically) understanding of and responsibilities for compliance with the *Contractor Rules of Behavior*, Appendix E relating to access to VA information and information systems.
- (2) Successfully complete the *VA Cyber Security Awareness and Rules of Behavior* training and annually complete required security training.
- (3) Successfully complete the appropriate VA privacy training and annually complete required privacy training; and
- (4) Successfully complete any additional cyber security or privacy training, as required for VA personnel with equivalent information system access.

b. The Contractor shall provide to the contracting officer and/or the COTR a copy of the training certificates and certification of signing the Contractor Rules of Behavior for each applicable employee within 1 week of the initiation of the contract and annually thereafter, as required.

c. Failure to complete the mandatory annual training and sign the Rules of Behavior annually, within the timeframe required, is grounds for suspension or termination of all physical or electronic access privileges and removal from work on the contract until such time as the training and documents are complete.

15.11. Contractor Personnel Security Requirements.

If the contract requires taking VA data to a Contractor site and the data contains PII and/or PHI, the Contractor shall provide an independent physical security assessment of their facility to the COR prior to commencing work. General guidelines for physical security can be found in VA Directive 0730, Section 6 (Physical Security).

All Contractor and subContractor personnel requiring access to VA facilities or VA network systems must undergo a background investigation and receive favorable adjudication by the Personnel Security Adjudication Center (PSAC) prior to access. Investigations shall be conducted in accordance with VA Directive 0710, Personnel Suitability and Security Program.

15.12. Contractor Responsibilities

Immediately after contract award, the COR will provide the Contractor with background investigation documents/information to be completed by the Contractor and returned to the COR to begin the background investigation process for all contract employees working on the contract who will have access to VA facilities, VA systems, or privacy data.

Upon receipt of the on-boarding documents from the COR. Upon notification of favorable fingerprint results, the Contractor may begin onboarding while the background investigation is ongoing. Thereafter, the Contractor will receive an email notification identifying the website link that includes detailed instructions regarding completion of the background clearance application process the Contractor employee shall complete the security questionnaire required for OPM to process the background investigation.

Contractors who have a current favorable background investigation previously conducted by OPM or PSAC will be reviewed for reciprocity. When a previous clearance is currently held, it does not stop the vendor from submitting a complete Background Investigation Package as stated above to the COR immediately after contract award for all contract employees who will be working on the contract.

The Contractor shall prescreen all personnel who require access to VA site(s) and/or access to VA LAN systems to ensure they maintain a U.S. citizenship or Alien Registration that authorizes them to work in the U.S. and are able to read, write, speak and understand the English language.

Contract onboarding shall not commence before:

Communicated favorable fingerprint results, or Confirmation that it has received the Contractor's investigative documents, the documents are complete, and that the investigation information has been released to OPM for scheduling of the background investigation, or Confirmation that the verified investigation will be reciprocated.

The COR will notify and forward the Contractor a copy of the Certificate of Eligibility (Form 4236) if the investigation has been reciprocated. The Contractor, if notified of an unfavorable adjudication by the Government, shall withdraw the employee from consideration from working

under the contract. Failure to comply with the Contractor personnel security requirements may result in termination of the contract for default.

The Contractor will be responsible for the actions of those contract and subcontract employees they provide to perform work for VA. In the event damage arises from work performed by Contractor personnel, under the auspices of the contract, the Contractor will be responsible for resources necessary to remedy the incident.

Should the Contractor use a vendor other than OPM or Defense Counterintelligence and Security Agency (DCSA) to conduct investigations, the investigative company must be certified by OPM/ DCSA to conduct Contractor investigations. The Vendor Cage Code number must be provided to the VA PSAC, which will verify the information and conclude whether access to the Government 's site(s) and/or VA LAN systems can be granted.

The investigative history for Contractor personnel working under this contract must be maintained in the databases of either OPM or the PSAC

15.13. Government Responsibilities

After the PSAC has adjudicated the background investigation package from the Contractor, the PSAC will send an e-mail notification to the Contractor and their POC identifying the e-QIP website link that includes detailed instructions regarding completion of the background clearance application process and the level of background that was requested.

Upon receipt of required investigative documents, PSAC will review the investigative documents for completion and initiate the background investigation by forwarding the investigative documents to OPM to conduct the background investigation. If the investigative documents are not complete, the PSAC will notify the vendor of deficiencies and include corrective instructions.

VA will pay for investigations and reciprocals processed through the VA PSAC and conducted by OPM in advance; however, the Contractor shall reimburse the full cost of background investigations/reciprocals to VA within 30 days of Bill of Collections from VA. VA shall send up to three plus one final delinquent notice to the Contractor. If the Contractor does not adhere to the Bill of Collections, future invoices may be subject to be offset by VA to recoup background investigation costs and may be considered grounds for default.

The COR will notify and forward the Contractor a copy of the Certificate of Eligibility (Form 4236) if the investigation has been reciprocated. The COR will also notify the Contractor of an unfavorable adjudication by the Government